

Union Cabinet sanctions ₹72.8 billion for rare earth magnet manufacturing

The Union Cabinet has greenlit ₹72.8 billion programme to create India's first integrated rare earth magnet manufacturing base. Targeting a domestic capacity of 6000 million tonnes per annum, the initiative aims to cut import dependence while supporting EVs, defence, electronics, and renewable energy. Financial incentives and subsidies will be rolled out over seven years.



Representational image

PEOPLE (on the move)



Amit Agarwal appointed as the new Telecommunications Secretary

Amit Agarwal has been appointed Secretary of the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), succeeding Neeraj Mittal, who has been appointed Secretary of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Agarwal, a

1993-batch IAS officer and former Secretary of Pharmaceuticals, UIDAI CEO, and Additional Secretary in Finance and MeitY, will lead India's telecom strategy, overseeing policy and infrastructure development.

Bosch's Michael Budde elected President of Europe's ESIA

Michael Budde, Bosch's President of Mobility Electronics, has been elected President of the European Semiconductor Industry Association (ESIA) for a two-year term. With over 25 years at Bosch, Budde will lead Europe's semiconductor sector amid scaling, AI, and sustainability challenges, focusing on ecosystem collaboration, implementation of the EU Chips Act, and advancing innovation to support strategic autonomy.



LG India promotes Sanjay Chitkara in post-IPO reshuffle



Sanjay Chitkara has been elevated to Co-Chief Sales and Marketing Officer at LG Electronics India as part of a post-IPO leadership reshuffle. He will work alongside Managing Director Hong Ju Jeon, who also assumes the Chief Sales and Marketing role and oversight of India manufacturing. The reorganisation strengthens market focus, operational integration and after-sales and HR leadership to support growth.

Mini-Circuits appoints Joseph Merenda as its first R&D Fellow

Mini-Circuits has appointed Joseph Merenda as its first R&D Fellow to strengthen long-term innovation in RF and microwave technologies. With 40 years of experience, Merenda will lead research programmes, advise on technology strategy, and foster engineering collaboration. His expertise spans system design, product development, and defence-related microwave innovations, supporting Mini-Circuits' growth and future readiness.

